
PAPERBOY

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

The Supreme Court refused to let the Postal Service impose new ballot-envelope rules on the midterms, and the 10-year Treasury touched 5% two days before a Fed meeting priced as a hike.

AI

Trump calls the AI-pacing campaign a "SICK conspiracy"

WHAT HAPPENED

Trump spent Monday attacking the frontier-lab slowdown argument. On Truth Social he wrote "[There is a SICK conspiracy going on against AI and data centers, and the only one that is happy about it is China,](#)" and that "The only control or 'guardrails' that AI needs is a STRONG AND SMART (High IQ!) PRESIDENT." To reporters he added: "I think you have a lot of negative forces that are bringing that up and they're bringing up things that won't happen." He referenced Dario Amodei directly, saying his administration had already stopped AI companies from doing things that were "bad, or potentially bad."

WHAT IT MEANS

Until the weekend, pacing was an argument between labs. By Monday it was a loyalty test. That reprises the Cruz-Klobuchar-Thune draft: any bill that reads as a brake now carries a veto shadow, and the labs in the standards-body working group have to decide whether admitting membership is worth the cost.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any lab confirms that working group on the record, and whether a bill number appears for the Senate AI draft.

Microsoft writes its own model rules, and Nadella takes the pacing side

WHAT HAPPENED

Microsoft published a [code of conduct for its in-house MAI models](#). Alongside general principles about supporting rather than replacing humans, it sets absolute prohibitions: no cyberattacks, no nuclear weapons development, no deepfakes. It also bars models from using "adaptive, deceptive, self-reinforcing, collusion, or other mechanisms" to circumvent human control or oversight. Satya Nadella said Microsoft "welcome[s] the research, focus, and deliberate pacing needed to get alignment right," and endorsed embedded third-party evaluators.

WHAT IT MEANS

Microsoft is the first company holding both a frontier lab and a hyperscaler's revenue to put alignment commitments on its own letterhead, where a regulator can later quote them back. Secondary coverage describes a public consultation window of six weeks; that length is unconfirmed and not in the primary write-up.

WATCH NEXT

A Microsoft post confirming the consultation, and whether Google or Meta publishes anything comparable.

Anthropic named as RUM's mystery compute buyer, but the filing says otherwise

WHAT HAPPENED

The Information reported that Anthropic is the unnamed customer behind RUM Group's (formerly Rumble) compute contract. The [8-K RUM filed on 24 August](#) confirms the money and mechanics: "approximately \$13.7 billion spread evenly across the three tranches," a six-year term, capacity from the company's Maysville, Georgia site, and warrants for 50,808,408 Class A shares at a \$0.01 exercise price. It names only "an unaffiliated U.S.-based third party cloud customer." Neither company has confirmed the pairing. RUM closed Monday at \$8.00, up 11.58%.

WHAT IT MEANS

If it is Anthropic, a company that spent the weekend arguing for slower deployment has bought six years of capacity from a Trump-aligned media firm on terms that hand it roughly 51 million shares for about \$508,000. Worth stressing: that identification is one paywalled outlet's claim, and the primary document declines to name anyone.

WATCH NEXT

Confirmation from either side, or an amended filing that names the customer.

The pacing selloff hit chips hardest, and Intel hardest of all

WHAT HAPPENED

Monday's decline concentrated in semiconductors and ordered itself oddly. Closes: Intel \$97.19, down 5.59%; AMD \$493.41, down 4.40%; Nvidia \$210.96, down 3.36%. The iShares Semiconductor ETF fell 5.63% against a 0.80% drop in the Nasdaq-100 ETF. Several widely circulated versions of these numbers overstated the damage by a third or more.

WHAT IT MEANS

Nvidia falling least and Intel most is the signature of a positioning unwind, not demand destruction. If investors genuinely thought AI capital spending was stopping, Nvidia would lead the way down. Amodei explicitly ruled out halting training, and Anthropic remains committed to deploying AMD's MI450.

WATCH NEXT

Micron's fiscal Q1 on 30 September and TSMC's September revenue around 10 October: the first hard demand numbers since the pacing argument started.

Cornelis raises \$205m to attack NVLink, with Qualcomm alongside

WHAT HAPPENED

Cornelis Networks, spun out of Intel in 2020, raised \$205 million led by IAG Capital Partners and launched Active Compute Fabric, an open-architecture interconnect pitched against Nvidia's NVLink and InfiniBand. Qualcomm Technologies announced a strategic collaboration on rack-scale AI data-centre networking, including joint evaluation for rack-scale inference. Chief executive Lisa Spelman: "AI infrastructure is reaching a point where faster endpoints alone are not enough. The fabric has to become an active part of the compute system." The product ships now, with a new generation expected later in 2026. Round stage, valuation and total raised were not disclosed.

WHAT IT MEANS

Interconnect is where Nvidia's moat is widest and least discussed. Qualcomm's involvement is the tell: having bought optionality with the AWS warrant, it now wants a fabric it does not rent from a competitor.

WATCH NEXT

Whether a named hyperscaler commits to Active Compute Fabric, and a date for the next generation.

Modi to open SEMICON India on 17 September

WHAT HAPPENED

SEMI confirmed on Monday that Narendra Modi will [inaugurate SEMICON India 2026 in New Delhi on 17 September](#), with the government meeting global semiconductor chiefs. India's stated target is a \$200 billion domestic market.

WHAT IT MEANS

India's pitch has moved from assembly and test toward fabrication, and this is the venue where commitments get announced. Treat announced capacity as intent rather than capital spending until a fab has a construction schedule.

WATCH NEXT

17 September, for any named fab commitment with a dollar figure attached.

BUSINESS

The 10-year touched 5% two days before a Fed meeting priced as a hike

WHAT HAPPENED

Monday's main event was in bonds, not equities. The 10-year Treasury traded above 5% intraday and [closed at 4.97%](#); the 30-year closed at 5.34%. On Treasury's published closes the 10-year has not settled at or above 5.00% since 20 August 2007, when it closed at 5.04%; the October 2023 peak close was 4.98%. So the widely repeated "first time since 2023" line holds only on an intraday basis. Goldman Sachs moved to forecasting a hike, with [David Mericle saying](#) "The report had little impact on our inflation view but pushed market pricing of a hike to nearly 90%." Hike odds are quoted at 80% on Polymarket and 88% by Schwab.

WHAT IT MEANS

The Fed is being asked to raise rates into a supply shock in order to defend the long end, which inverts the usual sequence. The current target range is 3.50-3.75%, set on 29 July.

WATCH NEXT

The decision on Wednesday 16 September, and the 2027 dot in the summary of economic projections.

OpenAI and Anthropic's listing paths split on the same day

WHAT HAPPENED

Sam Altman [told Fortune](#) that "given everything happening with safety, right now would be an ill-advised moment to go public," and "I would say not 2026"; he named no year. Anthropic has reportedly selected Nasdaq and could list as soon as October, at a valuation variously reported at \$2 trillion and \$2.3 trillion. Its S-1 was filed confidentially and is by definition not public, so none of the terms are verifiable; reported raise figures range from about \$60 billion to \$100 billion, none attributed on the record. For scale, SpaceX's June listing raised \$75 billion, or \$86.2 billion with the overallotment. Anthropic's annualised run-rate [passed \\$65 billion by end-July](#), roughly a sevenfold rise on year-end 2025.

WHAT IT MEANS

The IPO window is shut by choice rather than by price. The contradiction to watch is Anthropic listing at trillion-dollar scale while arguing publicly for slower deployment.

WATCH NEXT

A public S-1 in late September, which is the first document anyone can actually check.

Equities down modestly; oil still grinding up

WHAT HAPPENED

Indices fell about half a percent across the board, an orderly move next to bonds and chips. Brent front-month traded near \$106-107 and WTI October above \$103 [through Monday's session](#), both intraday futures quotes rather than settles, extending the shutdown of the Saudi East-West pipeline. Cybersecurity was the day's winner, with CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks each up more than 5%.

WHAT IT MEANS

A half-percent index decline against a 5.6% semiconductor drawdown says the AI trade took the damage, not the market. The oil bid is now a standing tax on everything the Fed is trying to cool.

WATCH NEXT

EIA diesel prices on Monday afternoons, and any Aramco statement on pipeline damage.

OpenAI reported to be buying Glass Imaging for more than \$300m

WHAT HAPPENED

The Wall Street Journal reported Monday that OpenAI is [acquiring Glass Imaging for over \\$300 million](#). The company was founded in 2019 in Los Altos by Ziv Attar and Tom Bishop, former Apple engineers who led the team that developed Apple's Portrait Mode, and had raised roughly \$30 million. Its technology uses neural networks to improve image quality at the moment of capture rather than in post-processing, learning the characteristics of each camera system. OpenAI did not respond to requests for comment. It follows the \$6.5 billion purchase of Jony Ive's io in 2025.

WHAT IT MEANS

OpenAI is buying the parts of a phone camera, which is the least ambiguous signal yet that the Ive device is camera-first rather than screen-first. At \$300 million for a company that raised \$30 million, this is a talent-and-patents price, not a product price. Both the deal and the number rest on one outlet.

WATCH NEXT

Confirmation from OpenAI, and whether Glass patents show up reassigned.

Monday's funding board went to Europe and Asia

WHAT HAPPENED

The day's rounds were almost all off the US tape, and all from [a single outlet](#), so the amounts are unconfirmed: Qupital (Hong Kong, e-commerce seller working capital) \$300 million in combined Series C equity and asset-backed commitments led by M Capital; Tandem Health (Stockholm, clinical documentation AI) about \$100 million Series B led by the Scaleup Europe Fund; Fortaegis (Amsterdam) \$50 million Series A led by Serendipity Capital, for cryptographic protections embedded in silicon for AI and defence systems; and Chift (Brussels, accounting and payments API connectivity) 10.5 million euros led by BlackFin Capital Partners.

WHAT IT MEANS

Fortaegis is the one worth marking. Silicon-level security sold into defence systems is exactly the turn the YC summer batch made a week ago, now showing up priced in a European Series A. The hardware-and-defence thesis is no longer confined to demo days.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of these amounts picks up a second source, and whether the US megadeal cadence resumes.

The Supreme Court will not let USPS police ballot envelopes before the midterms

WHAT HAPPENED

The Court [denied the government's stay application](#) in *USPS v. California*, No. 26A305, on 14 September, leaving the district court's preliminary injunction in place. The per curiam order reads: "The Government is unlikely to succeed on the merits of its challenge to the District Court's preliminary injunction. And the equitable factors applicable for obtaining emergency relief from this Court do not favor a stay." The blocked rule required federal ballot mail to carry an election-mail logo, envelopes scannable by high-speed equipment, and a barcode unique to each voter, with states submitting designs to the Postal Service and uploading basic voter information to a Postal Service portal. Kavanaugh concurred, writing that applying the rule in the 2026 elections "would be arbitrary and capricious in violation of the Administrative Procedure Act because state and local election officials do not have sufficient time to reasonably implement the rule." Alito dissented, joined by Thomas. No vote count was published.

WHAT IT MEANS

Fully briefed since 9 September and silent for five days, the Court took the narrowest ground available: timing, not authority. Kavanaugh went out of his way to allow the rule might sit within postal power. It simply cannot be imposed seven weeks out.

WATCH NEXT

Whether USPS refiles with a post-midterm effective date, and the UOCAVA ballot deadline on 19 September.

A judge blocks the visa "duration of status" repeal a day before it took effect

WHAT HAPPENED

Judge F. Dennis Saylor IV of the District of Massachusetts issued a [nationwide preliminary injunction on 14 September](#) against the July DHS rule that would have capped F and J academic visas at four years and I journalist visas at 240 days, one day before its 15 September effective date. The case is *Presidents' Alliance on Higher Education and Immigration v. DHS*, No. 1:26-cv-13799. Per [reporting of the ruling](#) (the opinion itself was not available), Saylor found that "the promulgation of the rule clearly failed to comply with the [APA]," called the department's national-security and fraud rationale "exceptionally weak," and wrote that "The damage to the higher education system and to the economy of the United States is likely to be catastrophic."

WHAT IT MEANS

Another loss for reorganisation-by-rulemaking, and the same defect as the others: a comment period too compressed to survive review. Note that the widely quoted "1.6 million" affected students is a wire figure, not the court's; the complaint cites 2024 admissions, a different basis.

WATCH NEXT

Whether DHS appeals to the First Circuit, and the FEMA remedy filing due 9 October.

One-vote cloture on a district judge; crypto market structure gets its test today

WHAT HAPPENED

The Senate returned Monday at 3:00pm and [voted 47-46 at 5:31pm](#) to invoke cloture on Matthew R. Byrne for the Southern District of Ohio, with seven senators not voting. The cloture motion on H.R. 3633, the Digital Asset Market Clarity Act, [ripens Tuesday 15 September at 2:15pm](#).

WHAT IT MEANS

A one-vote cloture margin on an uncontested district judge is the arithmetic every other item this autumn has to clear. H.R. 3633 needs sixty, which means it needs Democrats.

WATCH NEXT

Today at 2:15pm.

Russian strikes near the Polish border pull NATO into a reinforcement pledge

WHAT HAPPENED

Russia struck a train in Ukraine near the Polish border on Sunday and hit a second site close to another crossing; [Al Jazeera reports](#) the train was hit minutes after a delegation including Boris Johnson and Carl Bildt had passed through the station. On Monday two cargo vessels were hit in the Black Sea and a suspected Russian military drone was recovered from the Baltic near Jaroslawiec, Poland. NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte pledged more support and said the alliance would strengthen its eastern defences: "The strikes yesterday on trains in Ukraine close to NATO territory again show Putin's desperation and also his desire to sow fear and terror." Donald Tusk warned of "very intensified actions on the Russian side"; Kaja Kallas said the attacks were "clearly meant to scare Western countries from supporting Ukraine." Dmitry Peskov said Russian forces operate "across the entire territory of Ukraine ... and will continue to do so."

WHAT IT MEANS

The strikes cluster on the corridor that carries Western materiel and Western visitors, which makes them a message about the supply line rather than the front. Trump's claim that both sides had agreed to spare energy infrastructure has been confirmed by neither party. The strike specifics rest on one fetched outlet.

WATCH NEXT

Toronto on 28-29 September, and whether the truce terms are ever published.

Israel's campaign reaches the defence budget, and a Likud without Netanyahu

WHAT HAPPENED

Netanyahu and Yair Lapid met Monday on increased defence funding, and the meeting [reportedly ended badly](#), with Lapid pushing to move money out of ultra-Orthodox coalition budgets to fund IDF expansion and Likud replying that "State revenues were higher than expected as a result of the government's economic policies." Separately Yoram Cohen, the former Shin Bet chief running second on Gadi Eisenkot's Yashar list, opened the door to governing with Likud if Netanyahu stepped aside: "When it comes to Likud, and also Smotrich, I would approach them if they accepted our principles," while ruling out any coalition including Itamar Ben Gvir's Otzma Yehudit. Both items come from a single liveblog.

WHAT IT MEANS

Cohen's line is the first time a senior figure in the anti-Netanyahu bloc has priced a coalition with Likud rather than purely against it. Take Netanyahu out and the arithmetic for 27 October stops being blocked-versus-blocked.

WATCH NEXT

The Israeli election on 27 October, and whether Eisenkot endorses or disowns the position.

Sweden's count moves one point and nothing changes

WHAT HAPPENED

[SVT's result page](#), stamped 95% counted (6,312 of 6,626 districts) at 6:28pm on 14 September and still marked preliminary, has the left side on 176 seats and the right on 173 against a 175-seat threshold. S 28.1% and 100 seats (down 7), M 19.9% and 70 (up 2), SD 17.5% and 62 (down 11). Turnout was 80.3%. The count moved from 94% to 95% and the bloc numbers did not move.

WHAT IT MEANS

Nothing is decidable until the late early and overseas ballots land. For the record, the claim circulating that 28.1% is the Social Democrats' worst result since 1928 is wrong: their floor is 2018, at 28.26%.

WATCH NEXT

Wednesday 16 September for the late and overseas ballots, and a final county-board result around 21 September.

SOURCES

[Supreme Court - order in USPS v. California, No. 26A305 \(14 Sept\)](#)

[US Treasury - daily yield curve, 2026](#)

Senate - roll call vote 232, cloture on Byrne nomination

Senate Daily Digest - floor schedule, 14-15 Sept

SEC - RUM Group 8-K, 24 August 2026

SEMI - Modi to inaugurate SEMICON India 2026

Presidents' Alliance - duration of status litigation

STAT - court halts DHS visa limits on foreign scholars

Al Jazeera - Trump calls AI control calls a "sick conspiracy"

Al Jazeera - NATO pledges increased support after rail strikes

TechCrunch - Microsoft's new AI code of conduct

TechCrunch - Cornelis raises \$205m

TechCrunch - OpenAI buys Glass Imaging (report)

Fortune - Altman on an "ill-advised moment" to go public

Axios - Anthropic revenue run-rate

Yahoo Finance - 10-year yield climbs to 5%

Yahoo Finance - markets live, Monday 14 September

Tech Startups - funding board, 14 September

Times of Israel - liveblog, 14 September

SVT - Swedish election result (preliminary)

stockanalysis.com - INTC, AMD, NVDA closes 14 September